

Supplemental Materials: Partisan vs Climate Cues and Public Opinion about Trump's Actions on Energy

Matthew C. Nowlin*

Methods and Robustness Checks

Survey Sample

Despite the use of Census-informed quotas, the sample recruited from Cloud Research was not perfectly representative of the US population. To address this, I used the `survey` and `anesrake` packages in R to perform iterative raking to compute survey weights that align the sample with the US Census's 2023 American Community Survey (ACS) on key demographic variables, including age, race, gender, and education. Additionally, I used the Pew Research Center's National Public Opinion Reference Survey (NPORS) from 2025 to align the sample on political party affiliation. Table 1 compares the unweighted and weighted sample on the demographic and party variables used as raking targets.

Robustness: Results Without Survey Weights

The analysis presented in the manuscript used the survey weights. To confirm that the main results are not a product of the weights, I re-estimate the preregistered H1-H4 specification with unweighted OLS, using the same model as in the manuscript's main results table. Table 2 reports the results. The estimates are substantively unchanged from the weighted analysis, indicating that the cue and interaction effects are not simply an artifact of the weights.

* Associate Professor, Department of Political Science, University of Texas at Arlington. Email: matthew.nowlin@uta.edu

Table 1: Unweighted vs. Weighted Means on Demographic and Party Variables

Variable	Unweighted	Weighted	Difference
Age (years)	43.624	47.287	3.663
Male	0.489	0.472	-0.017
White (non-Hispanic)	0.677	0.599	-0.078
College graduate	0.556	0.362	-0.194
Democrat	0.563	0.450	-0.113
Republican	0.287	0.460	0.173

Weights computed via iterative raking (survey/anesrake) to US Census 2023 ACS demographic targets and Pew NPORS 2025 party-affiliation targets. See Data and Measures.

Covariate Balance Across Conditions

Respondents were randomly assigned to the Trump, climate, or control conditions. Table 3 compares demographic covariates and the political-belief moderators across the three conditions to confirm that random assignment produced comparable groups.

Robustness: Controlling for Demographic Covariates

The models reported in the manuscript do not include demographic controls. To confirm that the cue and interaction effects are not driven by any residual demographic imbalance across conditions, I re-estimate the preregistered H1-H4 specification with age, sex (male), race (white), and income added as additive controls. Table 4 reports the results, with control coefficients omitted from display. Most cue and interaction effects are substantively unchanged from the manuscript’s main models; the one exception is the Trump cue x conservative Republican interaction for cancelling the offshore wind project, which is marginally significant without controls ($p = .095$) but falls just short of the $p < .10$ threshold with controls added ($p = .117$).

Exploratory Model: Climate Cue x Education

As noted in the manuscript, H3 and H4 hypothesized that education would moderate the Trump cue’s effect on conservative Republicans and liberal Democrats. Table 5 reports an exploratory (not preregistered) model that adds the parallel climate-cue x college interactions to check whether education also moderates the climate cue’s effect. As with the Trump cue, there were no significant differences.

Table 2: Weighted OLS Models of Support for Trump's Energy Actions (Unweighted)

	Tax Credits	Coal Open	Coal Leasing	Cancel Wind	Nuclear
Trump Cue	−0.049 (0.111)	0.005 (0.108)	−0.076 (0.110)	−0.050 (0.108)	−0.321* (0.137)
Climate Cue	0.247** (0.083)	0.224** (0.081)	0.035 (0.082)	0.164* (0.081)	0.001 (0.103)
Cons. Republican	1.057*** (0.104)	1.015*** (0.102)	0.942*** (0.104)	1.025*** (0.102)	0.631*** (0.129)
Lib. Democrat	−0.500*** (0.094)	−0.607*** (0.091)	−0.641*** (0.093)	−0.337*** (0.092)	−0.298* (0.116)
College	0.138† (0.083)	0.017 (0.081)	−0.058 (0.082)	0.165* (0.081)	0.291** (0.102)
Trump x ConRep	0.236 (0.165)	0.216 (0.161)	0.352* (0.164)	0.256 (0.161)	0.415* (0.204)
Climate x ConRep	−0.398*** (0.120)	−0.311** (0.117)	−0.137 (0.119)	−0.240* (0.117)	−0.046 (0.148)
Trump x LibDem	−0.049 (0.143)	−0.123 (0.139)	−0.067 (0.142)	−0.107 (0.140)	−0.152 (0.177)
Climate x LibDem	−0.222* (0.105)	−0.206* (0.102)	−0.019 (0.104)	−0.155 (0.102)	−0.092 (0.130)
Trump x College	0.066 (0.143)	0.030 (0.139)	0.105 (0.142)	0.188 (0.140)	0.200 (0.177)
College x ConRep	−0.089 (0.120)	−0.061 (0.117)	0.011 (0.119)	−0.107 (0.117)	−0.229 (0.148)
College x LibDem	−0.178† (0.106)	−0.036 (0.103)	−0.040 (0.105)	−0.264* (0.103)	−0.210 (0.131)
Trump x ConRep x College	−0.299 (0.212)	−0.063 (0.206)	−0.176 (0.211)	−0.452* (0.207)	−0.090 (0.262)
Trump x LibDem x College	−0.086 (0.181)	−0.112 (0.176)	−0.141 (0.179)	−0.110 (0.176)	−0.096 (0.223)
Intercept	1.970*** (0.072)	2.260*** (0.070)	2.240*** (0.071)	1.750*** (0.070)	2.864*** (0.089)
Num.Obs.	3113	3113	3113	3113	3113
R ²	0.304	0.340	0.334	0.280	0.136

† p < 0.1, * p < 0.05, ** p < 0.01, *** p < 0.001

Unweighted OLS (lm), same specification as the weighted models in the manuscript's main results table. Reference categories: control condition, moderate/other political identity, no college degree.

Table 3: Covariate Balance Across Experimental Conditions

Variable	Control	Climate	Trump	p-value			
Age (years)	42.63	44.51	43.76	0.019			
Male	49.1	69.5	56.1	4.71	4.61	4.55	0.415
Conservative Republican	25.3	45.7					
Liberal Democrat							

Cell entries are unweighted condition means: percentages for binary indicators and means for continuous measures. The p-value tests for differences across the three conditions (chi-square for indicators, one-way ANOVA for continuous measures); non-significant values indicate the covariate is balanced across conditions, as expected under random assignment.

Note: the Trump-approval corroborating analysis (a continuous, post-treatment measure of Trump approval substituted for the ideology x party identity measures) is reported in the manuscript's Results section rather than here, since it bears directly on the main text's interpretation of the Trump-cue mechanism.

Table 4: Weighted OLS Models of Support for Trump's Energy Actions (With Demographic Controls)

	Tax Credits	Coal Open	Coal Leasing	Cancel Wind	Nuclear
Trump Cue	-0.036 (0.137)	-0.071 (0.143)	-0.112 (0.149)	-0.041 (0.116)	-0.316* (0.161)
Climate Cue	0.312** (0.119)	0.205† (0.117)	0.083 (0.113)	0.161 (0.106)	-0.109 (0.120)
Cons. Republican	1.134*** (0.134)	0.984*** (0.134)	0.966*** (0.130)	1.120*** (0.130)	0.515*** (0.143)
Lib. Democrat	-0.467*** (0.110)	-0.635*** (0.116)	-0.595*** (0.114)	-0.304** (0.096)	-0.309* (0.127)
College	0.209† (0.116)	0.101 (0.114)	0.067 (0.110)	0.321** (0.115)	0.211† (0.113)
Trump x ConRep	0.306 (0.209)	0.333† (0.197)	0.450* (0.204)	0.325 (0.207)	0.485* (0.223)
Climate x ConRep	-0.446** (0.167)	-0.243 (0.156)	-0.095 (0.157)	-0.215 (0.163)	0.113 (0.167)
Trump x LibDem	-0.085 (0.157)	-0.084 (0.167)	-0.090 (0.172)	-0.150 (0.134)	-0.172 (0.198)
Climate x LibDem	-0.251† (0.137)	-0.187 (0.137)	-0.096 (0.132)	-0.161 (0.121)	0.115 (0.147)
Trump x College	0.068 (0.190)	0.041 (0.186)	0.126 (0.198)	0.102 (0.182)	0.131 (0.196)
College x ConRep	-0.242 (0.161)	-0.214 (0.149)	-0.185 (0.151)	-0.352* (0.166)	-0.305† (0.159)
College x LibDem	-0.279* (0.131)	-0.156 (0.132)	-0.165 (0.126)	-0.415*** (0.125)	-0.347* (0.139)
Trump x ConRep x College	-0.387 (0.281)	-0.077 (0.256)	-0.170 (0.276)	-0.356 (0.289)	-0.049 (0.277)
Trump x LibDem x College	-0.002 (0.213)	-0.045 (0.213)	-0.104 (0.222)	0.038 (0.199)	0.083 (0.241)
Intercept	1.924*** (0.124)	2.272*** (0.121)	2.246*** (0.120)	1.673*** (0.117)	2.299*** (0.130)
Num.Obs.	3113	3113	3113	3113	3113
R ²	0.335	0.372	0.364	0.321	0.231

† p < 0.1, * p < 0.05, ** p < 0.01, *** p < 0.001

Survey-weighted OLS (svyglm), adding age, male, white, and income as additive controls to the specification in the manuscript's main results table. Control coefficients omitted from display; reference categories as in the manuscript's main results table.

Table 5: Exploratory Model: Climate Cue x Education (Not Preregistered)

	Tax Credits	Coal Open	Coal Leasing	Cancel Wind	Nuclear
Trump Cue	-0.003 (0.143)	-0.043 (0.150)	-0.080 (0.154)	-0.025 (0.120)	-0.318† (0.177)
Climate Cue	0.385* (0.156)	0.273† (0.156)	0.163 (0.149)	0.194 (0.127)	-0.114 (0.172)
Cons. Republican	1.104*** (0.149)	0.973*** (0.150)	0.921*** (0.144)	1.093*** (0.144)	0.481** (0.172)
Lib. Democrat	-0.502*** (0.121)	-0.627*** (0.130)	-0.597*** (0.128)	-0.330** (0.104)	-0.424** (0.155)
College	0.269† (0.151)	0.174 (0.161)	0.141 (0.149)	0.315* (0.158)	0.281† (0.159)
Trump x ConRep	0.334 (0.219)	0.343 (0.209)	0.468* (0.212)	0.370† (0.218)	0.579* (0.249)
Climate x ConRep	-0.419† (0.221)	-0.254 (0.210)	-0.074 (0.209)	-0.172 (0.209)	0.282 (0.238)
Trump x LibDem	-0.056 (0.165)	-0.090 (0.177)	-0.091 (0.181)	-0.128 (0.140)	-0.107 (0.218)
Climate x LibDem	-0.222 (0.187)	-0.216 (0.190)	-0.120 (0.181)	-0.144 (0.155)	0.191 (0.215)
Trump x College	-0.026 (0.215)	-0.056 (0.218)	0.019 (0.222)	0.063 (0.214)	0.174 (0.231)
College x ConRep	-0.186 (0.218)	-0.220 (0.213)	-0.133 (0.209)	-0.277 (0.233)	-0.100 (0.235)
College x LibDem	-0.263 (0.173)	-0.227 (0.186)	-0.234 (0.176)	-0.408* (0.173)	-0.208 (0.202)
Trump x ConRep x College	-0.459 (0.318)	-0.082 (0.299)	-0.220 (0.312)	-0.465 (0.335)	-0.262 (0.334)
Trump x LibDem x College	-0.027 (0.241)	0.025 (0.251)	-0.042 (0.254)	0.024 (0.233)	-0.094 (0.287)
Intercept	1.951*** (0.104)	2.310*** (0.110)	2.232*** (0.105)	1.744*** (0.086)	2.923*** (0.123)
Climate x College	-0.191 (0.228)	-0.186 (0.224)	-0.212 (0.217)	-0.074 (0.225)	0.072 (0.229)
Climate x ConRep x College	-0.075 (0.324)	0.040 (0.298)	-0.058 (0.303)	-0.123 (0.334)	-0.418 (0.330)
Climate x LibDem x College	-0.010 (0.261)	0.144 (0.263)	0.140 (0.253)	0.004 (0.248)	-0.241 (0.286)
Num.Obs.	3113	3113	3113	3113	3113
R ₂	0.331	0.368	0.359	0.314	0.165

† $p < 0.1$ * $p < 0.05$ ** $p < 0.01$ *** $p < 0.001$